

Taylor D. Sparks

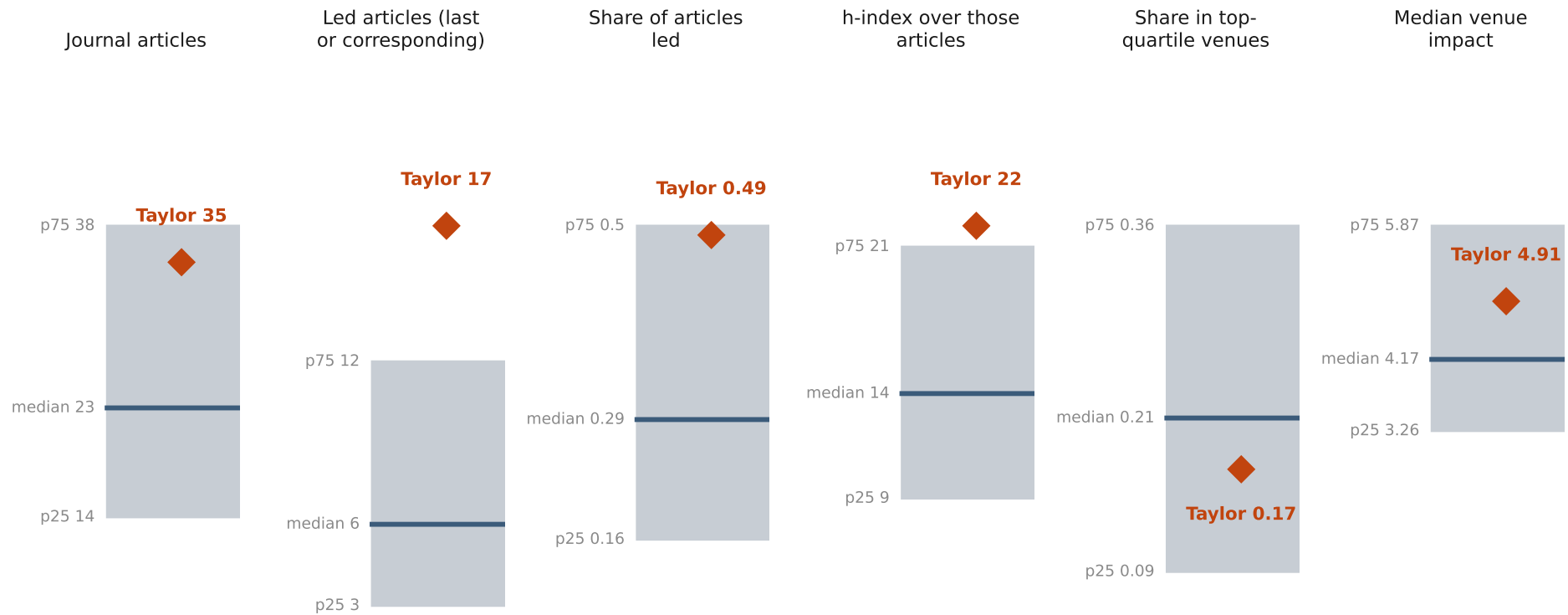
against materials chemistry, at career year 6

Taylor D. Sparks began a tenure-line appointment at University of Utah in 2013, which makes this career year 14. The comparison is made at year 6.

The cohort is 1091 people, each estimated to have begun a first independent faculty appointment between 2008 and 2018 in materials chemistry. Taylor D. Sparks is not among them.

These numbers describe what a group of people did. They are not a standard, nobody in the cohort agreed to be measured, and no part of this says what any one career should look like.

Taylor D. Sparks and the cohort



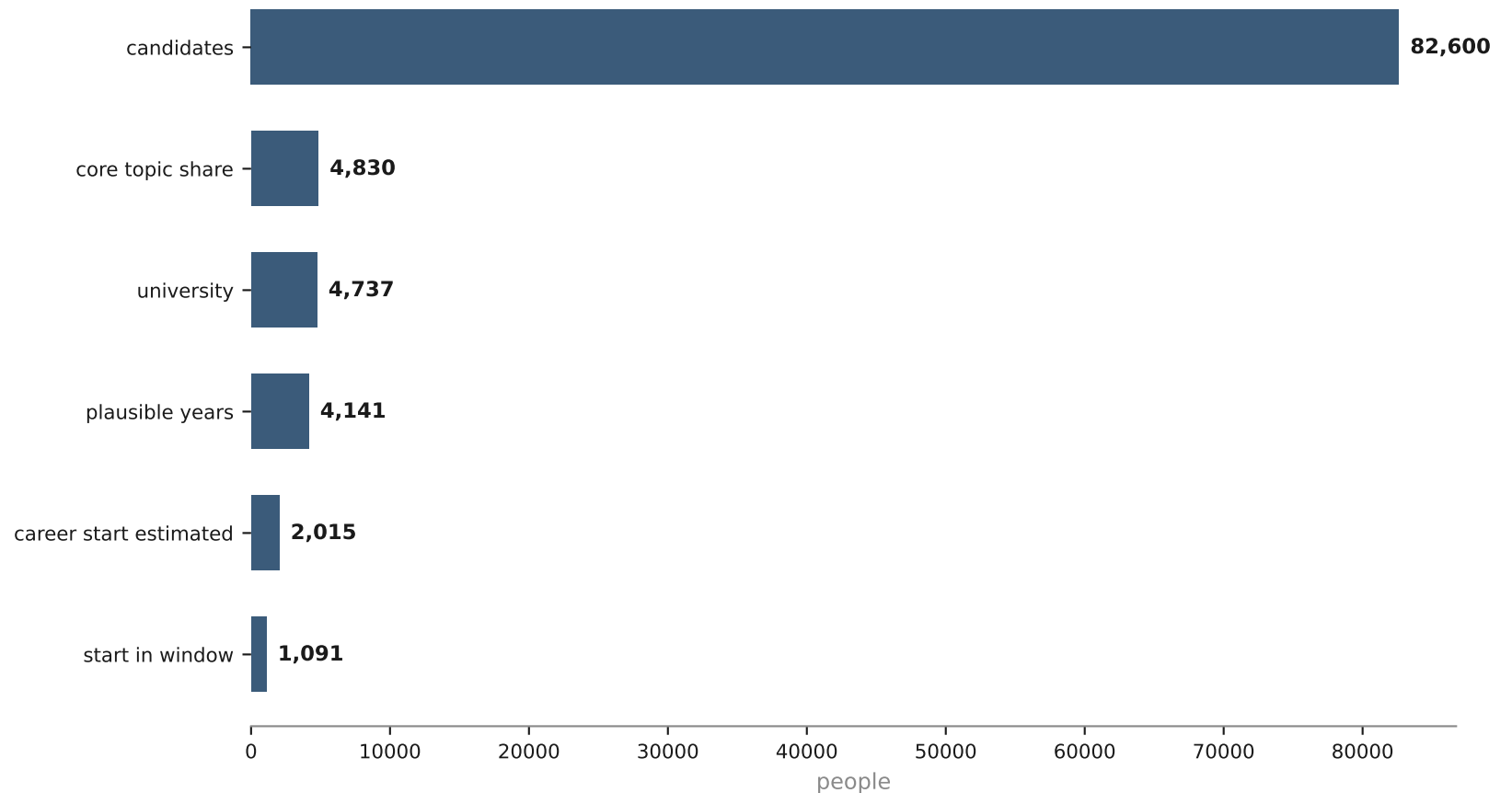
Citations to those articles: 2593 for Taylor D. Sparks, against a cohort p25 to p75 of 410 to 2128. Shown, and deliberately not placed: the cohort's papers in this window are years older, so putting one count against the other would measure the calendar rather than the work.

What the subfield published through year 6

Metric (through year 6)	p25	Median	p75
Journal articles	14 (13 to 14)	23 (22 to 25)	38 (36 to 40)
Led articles (last or corresponding)	3 (3 to 3)	6 (5 to 6)	12 (11 to 13)
Share of articles led	0.16 (0.14 to 0.17)	0.29 (0.27 to 0.31)	0.5 (0.46 to 0.5)
Citations to those articles	410 (362 to 448)	942 (853 to 1036)	2128 (1940 to 2394)
h-index over those articles	9 (8 to 9)	14 (13 to 15)	21 (20 to 22)
Share in top-quartile venues	0.09 (0.08 to 0.11)	0.21 (0.2 to 0.23)	0.36 (0.33 to 0.38)

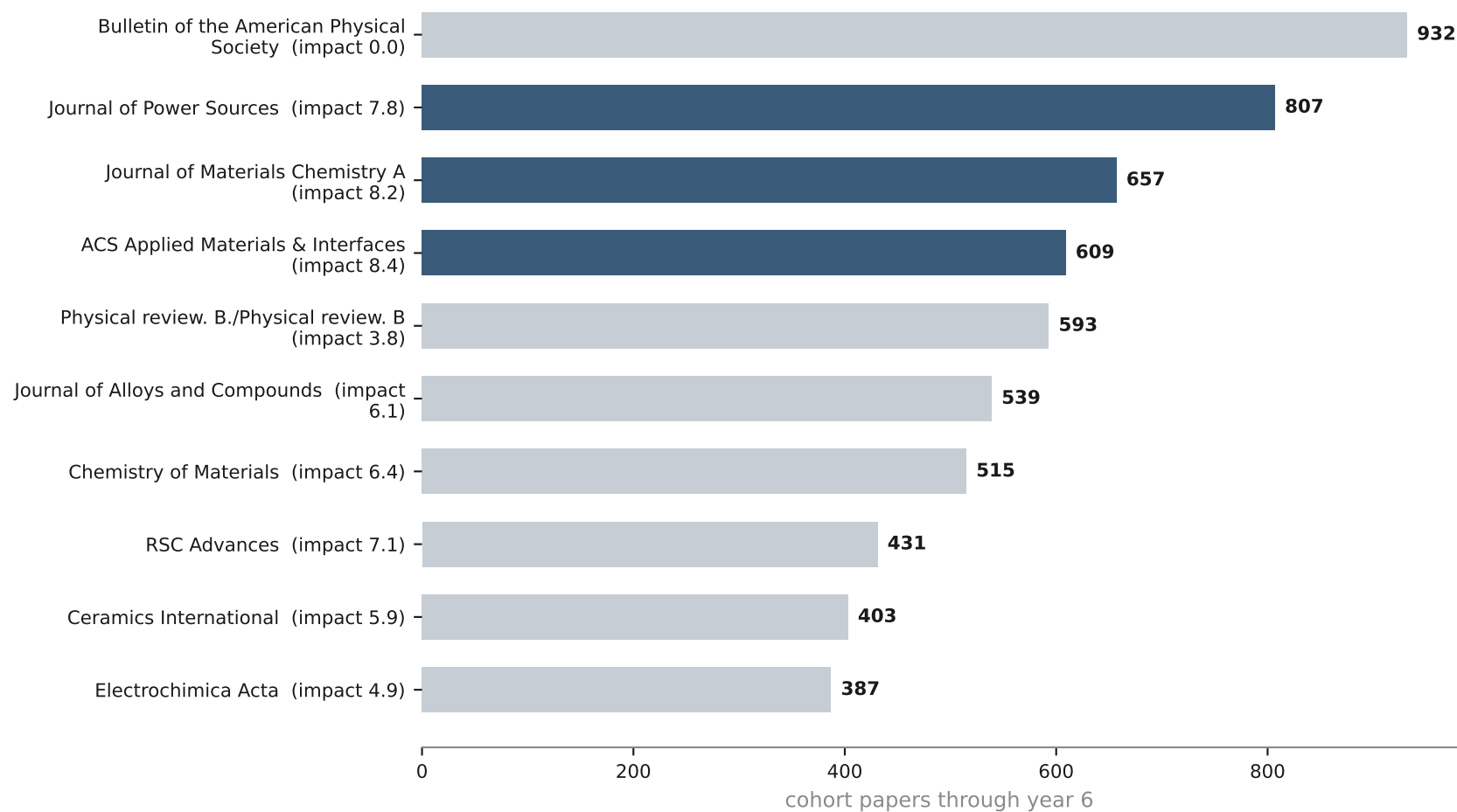
Parentheses are 95% cluster-bootstrap confidence intervals, resampling people rather than papers, because one person's papers are not independent of each other. A top-quartile venue is top quartile inside this cohort's own venue list, not globally. The cohort is 1091 people.

How the cohort was built



Each filter and how many people it left. This is the page to read first when a cohort looks wrong: a step that removes almost everybody, or almost nobody, is usually the one to question. The exact rule for each step is in [results/funnel.csv](#) and in [docs/methods.md](#).

Where the subfield publishes



The journals this cohort actually used, so that a top-quartile venue can be checked against titles rather than taken on trust. Darker shading marks the venues that are top quartile within this cohort. Impact is 2-year mean citedness from OpenAlex, which is a property of a journal and not of any paper in it.

What this does not tell you

Teaching, mentoring, service, funding, software, datasets, and public scholarship do not appear in OpenAlex, and they are a large part of the job. A publication record is not a person.

Citations are shown and not compared. The cohort's window papers are years older than the subject's, and citations accumulate with time, so placing one count against the other would measure the calendar.

Career start is inferred from publication patterns, not from HR records. For the subject it is supplied; for the cohort it is estimated, and the people it could not be estimated for were dropped rather than guessed at.

OpenAlex splits some people across profiles and merges others with namesakes. The cohort keeps only the people it could identify confidently, which tilts it slightly toward distinctive names.

Journal impact is a property of a journal, not of a paper in it. Venue quartiles are computed inside this cohort's own venue list because citation cultures differ enormously between subfields.

These are descriptive ranges of what a group of people did. A department that reads the median as something everyone must reach has misread this document.